> the two of us—to find a practical way to solve critical issues—the two I have mentioned—by the time we meet in Washington?
>
> Please convey regards from Nancy and me to Mrs. Gorbachev. We genuinely enjoyed meeting you in Geneva and are already looking forward to showing you something of our country next year.
>
> Sincerely yours,
> Ronald Reagan
> November 28, 1985

A week or so later, I sent a second letter to Moscow that was delivered to Gorbachev by Commerce Secretary Mac Baldrige, who was on another trade mission. This time, I raised other issues I felt had to be dealt with before we could achieve normal relations. They included, I said,

> the broad question of emigration, whether of members of such groups as Jews, Armenians and others, or of some internationally known individuals. In both categories, we are talking about quite poignant cases. The young pianist I mentioned to you falls into the category of someone whose requests to emigrate have been refused. The political importance of resolving such well known cases as the Sakharovs, Scharansky and Yuri Orlov cannot be overestimated. We are not interested in exploiting these cases. Their resolution will permit greater prominence for other issues in our relationship . . . the issues I have laid out in this letter are serious ones. Progress here would provide an enormous impetus to the resolution of other outstanding problems. Lack of progress will only hold us back.